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RSNA® Radiological Society of North America

June 16, 2025

Re: Docket CMS-2025-0050

Executive Summary:

The Radiological Society of North America (RSNA) applauds federal efforts to build a truly interoperable Health Technology Ecosystem. However, medical imaging remains insufficiently integrated into national data-sharing initiatives today. To close this critical gap, we urge CMS, ASTP/ONC, and HHS to take two targeted actions that will ensure every patient and provider can securely access imaging studies alongside other health data.

- **Mandate Imaging Standards in Certification:**
  Require all certified Health IT products to support DICOMweb, HL7 FHIR Imaging profiles, and relevant IHE integration frameworks for patient- and provider-requested image retrieval.
- **Include Imaging in TEFCA QHIN Requirements:**
  Expand the Trusted Exchange Framework and Common Agreement (TEFCA) Qualified Health Information Network (QHIN) framework to formally recognize and onboard imaging-capable QHINs, ensuring diagnostic images flow seamlessly across networks.

Request for Information; Health Technology Ecosystem

The Radiological Society of North America (RSNA) is pleased to provide this response to the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS), Assistant Secretary for Technology Policy (ASTP)/Office of the National Coordinator for Health Information Technology (ONC), and the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) regarding their request for information (RFI) on the Health Technology Ecosystem (Docket CMS-2025-0050).

The Radiological Society of North America (RSNA) is a nonprofit organization representing over 52,000 medical imaging professionals in more than 150 countries worldwide. The RSNA Scientific Assembly and Annual Meeting is the world's largest radiology conference, drawing tens of thousands of radiologists, researchers, and industry leaders from around the globe. RSNA's mission is to promote excellence in patient care and healthcare delivery through education, research, and technological innovation.

RSNA strongly supports the efforts of CMS, ASTP/ONC and other federal agencies to build a more connected healthcare technology ecosystem through initiatives such as the Health IT Certification Program, the expanding Core Data for Interoperability (USCDI) and the TEFCA nationwide framework for health information sharing. These programs have laid the groundwork for seamless data access across health information networks.

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Medical imaging data, however, remains insufficiently integrated into these efforts. While radiology is among the most highly valued and widely used diagnostic tools, patients and their care providers still frequently do not have a convenient way to access medical imaging studies, particularly when (as is commonly the case) the care process spans institutional boundaries. This gap leads to unnecessary delays, inconvenience, frustration, and expense, and seriously compromises the safety, efficiency, and quality of patient care. RSNA thus urges ASTP/ONC to recognize imaging as a high priority in national interoperability planning and implementation.

RSNA stands ready to work with ASTP/ONC better to integrate medical imaging into the national health information ecosystem. RSNA has a long and successful history of working to advance standards-based interoperability in health IT.

- RSNA is a founder of the Integrating the Healthcare Enterprise (IHE) initiative, which has published implementation guides for the use of data standards (HL7, DICOM, W3C, and others) that provide the foundation for healthcare institutions and health information networks around the world.
- RSNA partnered with the Sequoia Project to establish the Image Share Validation Program to test imaging systems for interoperability and conformance with data standards.
- The RSNA annual meeting has hosted multi-vendor demonstrations critical to advancing imaging technology, including the first public demonstrations of the DICOM standards, and continues to promote standards-based interoperability as an accelerator of innovation, most recently in the Radiology Reimagined demonstrations that showcase the successful integration of AI tools in medical imaging.

These efforts underscore RSNA's commitment to fostering a connected, patient-centered health information ecosystem.

We provide our responses to the RFI's specific questions as follows:

Questions PC-2c; PC8a; PR-3; and TD-9

Medical images are a critical component of the electronic health record and should be made conveniently and securely accessible to patients and their providers across care settings and geographic areas. Mature data standards and implementation guidance are in place to provide this capability today. Doing so will provide substantial benefits in reducing redundant imaging, enabling better-informed care decisions, and expediting care delivery.

To achieve these goals, RSNA recommends that ASTP/ONC **expand the Health IT Certification Program to mandate convenient access to medical imaging**. Require certified health information technology systems to support DICOMweb, HL7 FHIR, and IHE standards necessary to enable seamless access to medical imaging for patients and their care providers.

Questions PC-10; PC-11; and PR-6

RSNA supports the TEFCA process and expansion of QHINs as an important pathway for enabling patient and provider access to electronic health records. To fully realize the value of this network, it is critical that medical imaging be included in the body of accessible data.

RSNA thus recommends that ASTP/ONC **expand TEFCA to include imaging-capable QHINs**. Incorporate standard architectures for image sharing within TEFCA and formally recognize imaging-capable Qualified Health Information Networks (QHINs).

RSNA appreciates this opportunity to provide comments around the state of the health technology ecosystem. These targeted actions will help ensure that imaging data is an accessible component of the electronic health record, advancing a truly interoperable and patient-centered health information ecosystem.

Please contact RSNA's director of government relations, Libby O'Hare (eohare@rsna.org) for additional information or questions.

Sincerely,

Jeffrey Klein, MD

Chair of the Board

Radiological Society of North America